

eventually went on to famously develop the world's first Wearable Wireless Webcam.

It wasn't until the late 2000s that wearables really began gaining some traction in the technology market. A major contributor to this was the rise in popularity of smartphones and the widespread adoption of Bluetooth. In fact, almost all of today's wearables owe much to this versatile wireless standard. Bluetooth headsets were seen as a sort of indicator of professionalism and success. It was also a wearable that greatly boosted the wearer's productivity as it left their hands free for other important tasks, while also doing away with the hassle of wires.

Wearable music devices were also extremely popular, and the youth demographic was always on the lookout for easier ways to consume their media. Sony was known for its Walkman range of portable media players, although most of them were peripheral devices that required a set of earphones to use. Eventually, Sony decided to test the wearable market by designing and fervently marketing a pair of headphones that housed all the components of an MP3 player, making it the world's first wearable MP3 player.

The Current Scene in the Wearable Market Space

Nowadays, wearables are much more than just portable MP3 players and wireless headphones. The increase in the manufacture of microchip-sized sensors has seen developers increasing experiment with prototypes of innovative wearables. The more the tech barriers were brought down, the more startup-scale developers were encouraged to try new things.

One company that knows this all too well is Fitbit. Founded in 2007, this California-based startup is known for their fitness and health tracking wearable bands. At the end of Q2 2015, Fitbit had 23.4% share of the wearables market whilst enjoying a growth of 158% in market value. However, it wasn't always smooth sailing for them, as cofounder and CTO Eric Friedman claims there were more than a handful of times they were close to calling it quits. Fortunately for them, the company had about 25,000 orders at their product launch in Christmas 2009. CEO James Park says their success was down to the fact that 'it was the right product at the right time at the right price point'.

However, the biggest contributor to the sudden rise in development of wearable technology is the success of crowdfunding. Websites like Kickstarter and Indiegogo have been a massive boon for entrepreneurs